

BRAD GARD

KEYNOTE SPEAKER · MASTER ELECTRICIAN · TRAINING DIRECTOR, IBEW LOCAL 120

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THE FLAGSHIP KEYNOTE

Earned, Not Given

LEADERSHIP IS REVEALED THROUGH REAL RESPONSIBILITY - NOT HANDED OUT WITH A TITLE.

THE TALK

The skilled trades are superb at building technical mastery and far weaker at building leaders. Brad takes apart the habit at the root of it - promoting the best hand into a leadership role and assuming the rest will follow - and makes the case that a title is not the same as development, and that confusing the two quietly costs organizations their strongest people.

From there he walks the room through a real experiment: handing apprentices who had never led anyone direct responsibility for a hall full of Grade 8 students, then watching what that responsibility pulled out of them. It is a field-tested, story-driven look at how leadership actually forms, and a challenge to rethink how we grow people and who we invite into the trade in the first place.

WHAT THE ROOM WALKS AWAY WITH

- **Promotion is not development.** Why confusing the two quietly breaks your best people - and what to do instead.
- **Responsibility reveals leadership** that no course, title, or lecture ever could.
- **The one-to-one model** that turned skeptical apprentices into teachers in twenty-four hours.
- **Care, ownership, and pride** are leadership skills - and you can build them on purpose.
- **A Monday-morning challenge:** who in your world is one real responsibility away from rising?

THE MOMENT PEOPLE REMEMBER

By day two, an apprentice who had spent day one with his arms crossed drove across town, on his own time, for a single gold marker - for a kid he had known for a day. Why he did it is the heart of the talk.

THE PROOF · FEB 2026

38	Apprentices who led the day
105	Grade 8 students mentored, one-to-one
46%	Female participation, vs a 4% industry baseline. 11.5x the average.
60%	Visible minority participation
0	Safety incidents

WHAT THE ROOM SAID

> *Even though I realized the trades might not be for me, I still had so much fun.*
>
> ELLA, GRADE 8 STUDENT

> *My son has not stopped talking about it.*
>
> PARENT, FEB 2026 PROGRAM

IDEAL FOR

Trade associations and unions · Apprenticeship and training conferences · Leadership and workforce-development summits · Construction and industrial employers · Education audiences

FORMATS

Signature keynote	45-60 min
Conference slot	25-30 min
Keynote + facilitated Q&A	60-90 min

FROM THE ORGANIZER

"Brad Gard delivered 'Earned, Not Given' for NETCO, and it was a passionate, powerful speech. He speaks from over four decades in the electrical trade, and his message on leadership, mentorship, and recruitment is practical and honest. I would recommend Brad to any organization looking for a speaker who knows the trades from the inside."

CHRIS SWICK · EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR, NETCO

Brad Gard - Master Electrician & Training Director, IBEW Local 120. Four decades in the trade, on the tools since fourteen. Recent keynote: NETCO, Charlevoix.

BOOK THIS KEYNOTE

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